

Raul Mathias Leon

Brown University
Department of Economics
Providence, RI 02912

Phone: +1 (346) 814-7626
Email: raul_leon@brown.edu
Homepage: <https://raulmleon.github.io>

Education

Ph.D. Economics, Brown University	2025-2031
AM in Economics, Brown University	2026
MA in Public Policy Studies with a Certificate in Research Methods (Honors), University of Chicago	2023-2025
Apprenticeship under Prof. Steven N. Durlauf	
Bachelor of Economics (Honours), The University of Queensland	2022
First Class Honours in Econometrics	
Advisor: Prof. Rigissa Megalokonomou	
Bachelor of Economics, The University of Queensland	2019-2021
Major in Quantitative Methods	
Associate degree, Universidad Nacional de Música (Peru)	2016-2017
Major in Musical Performance with a Specialization in Oboe	
Under the Guidance of Maestro Carlos Otarola	

Research Experience

Research assistant for Prof. Toru Kitagawa	<i>June, 2026 - August, 2026</i>
Research assistant for Prof. James J. Heckman and Dr. Sadegh Eshaghnia	<i>August, 2023 - June, 2025</i>
Research assistant for Prof. Christopher Blattman and Prof. Scott Gehlbach	<i>March, 2024 - January, 2025</i>
Inequality Working Group, Stone Center, UChicago	<i>October, 2023 – May, 2025</i>
Research assistant for Prof. Ricardo Nieva	<i>November, 2022 - February 2023</i>

Teaching

Inequality: Theory, Methods, and Evidence (PhD level), Prof. Steven Durlauf, <i>Kenneth C. Griffin Department of Economics</i>	<i>Spring 2025</i>
Applied Econometrics III (PhD level), Prof. Koichiro Ito, <i>Harris School of Public Policy</i>	<i>Spring 2025</i>
Applied Econometrics II (PhD level), Prof. Ingvil Gaarder, <i>Harris School of Public Policy</i>	<i>Winter 2025</i>
Applied Econometrics I (PhD level), Prof. Steven Durlauf, <i>Harris School of Public Policy</i>	<i>Fall 2024</i>

Publications

Working Papers

“When Excellence Backfires: The Impact of Superstars on Peers” with Rigissa Megalokonomou (Monash)

“Neighborhoods, Family and Intergenerational Mobility” with Goya Razavi (NHH) and Sadegh Eshaghnia (UChicago)

“Spectral Identification of Deep Roots”

Work In Progress

“The Persistent Economic Cost of Genocide: An Intergenerational Study of the Stolen Generations” with Rigissa Megalokonomou (Monash)

“Are Neighborhood Rankings Reliable? A Forecast Coecient Approach” with Goya Razavi (NHH) and Cesar Chavez (UChicago)

“Who Moves to Opportunity? Selection on Gains in Refugee Neighborhood Choice” with Goya Razavi (NHH) and Cesar Chavez (UChicago)

“Personalist Autocracies and the Distortion of City Size Distributions” with Jorge Ochoa (Brown)

“Rigorous Sequential Inference in Economic Field Experiments: An E-process Approach”

“Beyond the Cutoff: An Optimal Transport Approach to Extrapolation in Regression Discontinuity Designs”

Conferences

Center for The Economics of Human Development, UChicago (2025); Inequality Working Group, Stone Center, UChicago (2025); Education Economics Workshop, Applied Young Economist Webinar, Warwick (2024)

Honors & Awards

Umezawa Stoltz fund award	2026
Bravo Center research fund award	2026
Graduate Student Scholarship, Brown University	2025-2031
Honorable Mention, NSF Graduate Research Fellowship Program	2025
Merit award, Harris School of Public Policy, The University of Chicago	2023-2025
I.S.E.O. Summer School Scholarship, Institute for Studies on Economics and Occupation	2024
Summer School Scholarship, Center for Monetary and Financial Studies	2023
Lima Summer SE Scholarship, Lima School of Economics	2023
Thomas A. Plein Endowed Scholarship, from University of Queensland	2022
Dean’s Commendation for Academic Excellence, from The University of Queensland	2021, 2022
UQ Future Leader, from The University of Queensland	2021
Latin America Global Leaders Scholarship, from The University of Queensland	2019

References

Distinguished Service Professor
Steven N. Durlauf
Harris School of Public Policy
sdurlauf@uchicago.edu

Professor
Christopher Blattman
Harris School of Public Policy
blattman@uchicago.edu

Associate Professor
Rigissa Megalokonomou
Monash University
rigissa.megalokonomou@monash.edu

Professor
Scott Gehlbach
Harris School of Public Policy
gehlbach@uchicago.edu